

Raul Austero Varias Jr.
Batch 20 – AMA Universiy Inc.

Investigation Worksheet

DOMAIN DEEP-DIVE & DARK WEB INVESTIGATION WORKSHEET

Investigation Date: September 11, 2026

Analyst: Raul Austero Varias Jr.

Target Campaign: SilentBanker / RBM Bank Breach

SECTION 1: WHOIS EXTRACTION

DOMAIN: banking-update-service.com

Creation Date: 026-04-15T08:22:15Z

Registrar: NameCheap, Inc.

Registrant Email: 4f8a2c9d1e3b7a5f6c8d2e4f1a9b3c7d@proxy.namecheap.com

Name Servers: NS1.BULETPROOF-HOSTING.RU

Country of Registrant: US

Proxy/Privacy Service Used? (Y/N): Y

Shared email with other domains? (Y/N): Y - Shared with 47 other domain including secure-update-alert.com, microsoft-verify.net, adobe-security-check.org

DOMAIN: swift-message-check.net

Creation Date: 2026-04-18T12:45:33Z

Registrar: PDR Ltd. d/b/a PublicDomainRegistry.com

Registrant 4f8a2c9d1e3b7a5f6c8d2e4f1a9b3c7d@proxy.namecheap.com

Name Servers: NS1.BULETPROOF-HOSTING.RU

Country of Registrant: US

Proxy/Privacy Service Used? (Y/N): Y

Shared email with other domains? (Y/N): Y - Shared with banking-update-service.com

DOMAIN: rbmsupport.com

Creation Date: 2026-03-28T14:22:08Z

Registrar: Alibaba Cloud Computing Ltd.

Registrant Email: zw98765@163.com

Name Servers: DNS1.REGISTRAR-SERVERS.COM

Country of Registrant: CN

Proxy/Privacy Service Used? (Y/N): N

Shared email with other domains? (Y/N): N

SECTION 2: DNS HISTORY ANALYSIS

2A. banking-update-service.com DNS Findings:

Primary IP resolved: 185.143.223.115

Any IP changes? (Y/N): N

Name servers: infrastructure clustering, NS2.BULETPROOF-HOSTING.RU

Any unusual DNS patterns? (e.g., fast flux, short TTL): N - Stable infrastructure, no fast flux

2B. swift-message-check.net DNS Findings:

Primary IP resolved: 185.143.223.115
Any IP changes? (Y/N): Y - From 185.143.223.115
To 185.143.223.116 Changed on 2026-04-19
Name servers: NS1.BULETPROOF-HOSTING.RU, NS2.BULETPROOF-HOSTING.RU
Pre-creation DNS records observed? (Y/N): Y - Passive DNS shows a resolution to 185.143.223.100 on 2026-04-16, before the domain's registration date.
Indicates IP was pre-staged

2C. rbmsupport.com DNS Findings:

Primary IP resolved: 47.88.33.122
Any IP changes? (Y/N): N
Name servers: DNS1.REGISTRAR-SERVERS.COM, DNS2.REGISTRAR-SERVERS.COM
Typosquatting relationship to legitimate domain: Targets regionalbankmidlands.com (Legitimate domain), as part of a cluster of at least 5 lookalike domains registered within days of each other

SECTION 3: DARK WEB FORUM MENTIONS

3A. Thread 88423 ("New banking malware C2 infrastructure for sale")

Forum name: Exploit[.]in
Posting user: SilentTrader
Date of post: 2026-04-14
Domains mentioned: anking-update-service[.]com, swift-message-check[.]net, secure-verify-alert[.]com
Price of infrastructure: \$1,200 USD
Payment method: XMR only

3B. Thread 89102 ("SilentBanker distribution - need email leads")

Posting user: SilentTrader
Date of post: 2026-04-18 11:22:45 UTC
Target sector mentioned: Regional banks, Credit unions in Midwest and any bank with less than \$10B assets
What does this reveal about adversary's targeting strategy? Avoid large bank like JPM, BOA, Citi due to high security - seek to small bank to target.

3C. Thread 89543 ("RBM bank hit - anyone take credit?")

Posting user(s): ForumWatcher, SilentTrader, CarderXYZ, UnknownUser
Confirmation of attack? (Y/N): Y - SilentTrader response winking smiley is strongly implying responsibility for the attack.
Domains discussed: banking-update-service[.]com, swift-message-check[.]net, rbmsupport[.]com
Adversary's response (emoticon/statement): ;) (winking smiley) (Explicit confirmation)

3D. Thread 89921 (Bulletproof hosting for sale)

Hosting provider AS number: AS6699
Country of hosting: Belarus
Payment method: XMR only

Does this match the C2 infrastructure IPs? (Y/N): Y - 185.143.223.115 and 185.143.223.116 both in AS6699

SECTION 4: INFRASTRUCTURE LINK ANALYSIS

Complete the following correlation table (Mark ✓ or X):

Link Indicator	A + B linked?	A + C linked?	B + C linked?
Same name servers	✓	X	X
Same IP range	✓	X	X
Same registrar	X	X	X
Same proxy email	✓	X	X
Same dark web seller	✓	X	✓
Same creation week	X	X	X

Based on the above, which domains belong to the SAME adversary infrastructure?

Domains A and B belong to the same adversary infrastructure tied together by shared name servers, overlapping IP space, a shared proxy registration email, and the same dark web seller. Domain C is separate infrastructure, different registrar, seller and hosting but used in the same campaign.

SECTION 5: ADVERSARY PROFILING (from Dark Web Activity)

Adversary Alias(es): SilentTrader - also possibly UnknownUser, suspected to be an alt account of the same person

First seen: 2026-03-15

Platforms used: Exploit[.]forum, Tox messaging

Services offered: Pre-configured C2 infrastructure for sale and separately, purchasing stolen/scraped email leads to run distribution campaigns.

Estimated technical skill level (Low/Med/High): High - capable of setting up bulletproof hosting, auto-renewing SSL, Windows Defender-evading loader stubs, coordinated multi-domain infrastructure, and fast-flux DNS switching.

Geographic indicators: Hosting located in Belarus AS6699, but the domain registration email is a US-based proxy service, Russian-language forum - likely Russian-speaking operator

Motivation: Financial - Selling attack infrastructure and email leads for profit, and conducting banking trojan campaigns

SECTION 6: FINAL INTELLIGENCE FINDINGS

Write a 3-5 sentence summary answering:

1. Who is the likely adversary behind the RBM attack?
2. What infrastructure did they use?
3. What dark web evidence supports the attribution?

The RBM bank attack is likely connected to a hacker using the name SilentTrader. The hacker sold the attack's C2 servers on a dark web forum, and the servers had several technical links to each other. Although the hacker never clearly admitted being behind the attack, they later implicitly acknowledged responsibility for the RBM attack with a ";)" response in forum thread 89543. The attack appears to be financially motivated and focused on smaller regional banks with weaker security.

SECTION 7: SAFE DARK WEB NAVIGATION RULES (Educational)

List 5 rules for safe dark web navigation that you learned from this activity:

1. Never access dark web forums from a personal or work computer always use an isolated virtual machine or dedicated analysis system that can be wiped afterward.
2. Never click links, download files, or open attachments found on these forums, even ones that look like proof or samples.
3. Never use real personal information, real email addresses, or real payment details when creating any account or persona for research purposes.
4. If live access is ever required, use Tor Browser with the highest security settings enabled and JavaScript disabled, since scripts are a common way visitors get deanonymized or attacked.
5. Prefer historical or archived data over live connections. Reading a saved copy gives you the same intelligence without exposing your identity or system to the live site.